NNN-B-001291 (DSA-DM)
March 4, 1970
Interim Revision of
MIL-B-3590
September 28, 1951

# INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

## BASKET, TEST TUBE

This interim Federal Specification was developed by the Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above. The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this interim Federal specification as a valid exception to Military Specification MIL-B-3590.

## 1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers coated and uncoated steel test tube baskets suitable for holding test tubes during drying, incubation or sterilization procedures.

1.2 Classification. Test tube baskets shall be of the following types and sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

1.2.1 Types.

| | |
|---|---|
| Type I | Uncoated |
| Type II | Neoprene Coated |
| Type III | Vinyl Coated |

1.2.2 Sizes.

| | |
|---|---|
| Size 1. | 6 in. by 6 in. by 6 in. |
| Size 2. | 9 in. by 9 in. by 9 in. |

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## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications, standards and drawings. The following specifications and standards, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

| | |
|---|---|
| PPP-B-566 | Boxes, Folding, Paperboard. |
| PPP-B-585 | Boxes, Wood, Wirebound. |
| PPP-B-601 | Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood. |
| PPP-B-621 | Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner. |
| PPP-B-636 | Box, Fiberboard. |
| PPP-B-676 | Box, Setup. |

Military

| | |
|---|---|
| MIL-L-10547 | Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof, or Waterproof, Flexible. |

STANDARDS

Federal

| | |
|---|---|
| FED-STD-123 | Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies) |

Military

| | |
|---|---|
| MIL-STD-105 | Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes. |
| MIL-STD-129 | Marking for Shipment and Storage. |

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.



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(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D.C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

(Copies of Military specifications, standards, and drawings required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publication. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society For Testing and Materials (ASTM)

D 883 Plastics, Nomenclature Relating to.

D 1784 Rigid Poly (vinyl chloride) and Poly-1; 2, Dichloroethlylene Compounds.

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Phila., Pa. 19103).

American Iron and Steel Institute (AISI)

For Corrosion Resistant Steel wire and Carbon Steel wire.

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the American Iron and Steel Institute, 150 East 42nd Street, New York, N. Y. 10017).



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## 3. REQUIREMENTS

### 3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Type I. Type I baskets shall be fabricated from AISI 302 or 304 wire as shown in AISI, and shall be furnished in a smooth, bright finish.

3.1.2 Type II. Type II baskets shall be fabricated from AISI 1008 or 1010 wire. The entire basket shall be neoprene coated after fabrication. Neoprene coating shall be 1/64 in. thick.

3.1.3 Type III. Type III baskets shall be fabricated from AISI 1008 or 1010 wire. The entire basket shall be vinyl coated after fabrication. Vinyl coating shall be 1/64 in thick.

3.2 Construction. Test tube baskets shall consist of a top frame, a bottom frame, vertical side wires, horizontal crosswires and a framed wire mesh mat. Top frame and bottom frame shall be formed into squares. The four sides of the baskets shall be formed by attaching the side wires vertically from the bottom frame to the top frame. Side wires shall be reinforced by the addition of horizontal crosswires. Side wires shall be parallel and shall be not more than 3/8 inches (in.) apart. Crosswires shall be parallel and shall be not more than 7/8 in. apart. Side wires shall lead upward to the inside of the top frame, and shall lead downward to the outside of the bottom frame. Ends of the wires shall be crimped and welded around the top and bottom frames. The bottom of the basket shall be made by the formation of a square frame, to which shall be spotwelded a mesh consisting of a square-weave design of four wires per inch. The framed square mesh bottom shall then be continuously welded to the top side of the bottom frame. All wires shall be welded at every point of intersection.

3.2.1 Style and design. Baskets shall conform to Figure I for style and design. Minor variations in design of the sides of the baskets shall be acceptable provided such variations do not affect performance and are not in conflict with the material requirements as specified herein.



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3.3 Dimensions. Dimensions and sizes for all baskets shall be as specified in Table I for the various components listed. Dimensions shall be expressed in terms of inches (in.). Linear dimensions shall have a tolerance of ± 1/8 in.

Table I. Dimensions

| Components | Diameter of Wire (Minimum) | Dimensions | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | Size 1 | Size 2 |
| Top frame | .162 | 6 by 6 | 9 by 9 |
| Bottom frame | .162 | 5-1/2 by 5-1/2 | 8-1/2 by 8-1/2 |
| Side wires | .054 | 6 high | 9 high |
| Crosswires | .054 | ---------- | ---------- |
| Frame of wire mesh | .094 | 5-1/2 by 5-1/2 | 8-1/2 by 8-1/2 |
| Wire mesh | .047 | 4 wire/in. | 4 wires/in. |

Dimensions on all frames specified under size 1 and 2 shall be overall dimensions.

3.4 Performance.

3.4.1 Type I. Uncoated baskets shall show no evidence of corrosion when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

3.4.2 Type II and type III. Neoprene-coated baskets and vinyl-coated baskets shall show no evidence of being dissolved when tested as specified in 4.4.2. Neither the neoprene coating nor vinyl coating shall show evidence of deterioration, discoloration, softening, mottling or crazing when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

3.5 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Test tube baskets shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.



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## 4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, in the contract or order, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to insure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties).

4.1.2 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality supplied by the manufacturer of the corrosion-resistant steel wire, carbon steel wire, neoprene and vinyl may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the FSN, the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, the individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels shall be as indicated in table II. The unit of product shall be one basket.

Table II. - Sampling for examination.

| Type defect | Inspection level | AQL (Percent defective) |
|---|---|---|
| For visual examination | | |
| Major defects | II | 1.0 |
| Minor defects | II | 4.0 |
| For dimensional examination | S-3 | 2.5 |



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4.2.2 For tests. Sampling of tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 for S-3 inspection level. Unit of product shall be one basket. Acceptance number shall be zero.

Table III. Sampling for tests

| Characteristic | Requirement | Test Procedure |
|---|---|---|
| Corrosion resistance | 3.4.1 | 4.4.1 |
| Continuity of Coating | 3.4.2 | 4.4.2 |
| Deterioration | 3.4.2 | 4.4.3 |

4.3 Examination. Baskets shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. The baskets shall be examined for defects including, but not limited, to those listed in table III.

4.3.1 Classification of defects. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with the following classification of defects:

Table IV. - Classification of defects

| Category | Defect |
|---|---|
| Major | |
| 101 | Wires not welded at points of intersection. |
| 102 | Vertical wires not smoothly crimped around top and bottom frames. |
| 103 | Basket not free of sharp edges and burrs. |
| 104 | Basket not free from weld burns. |
| 105 | Welds not free from pits and porosity. |
| 106 | Wires on bottom frame not free of breaks. |
| 107 | Basket not free of deformation. |
| 108 | Coating not uniformly applied. |
| 109 | Wires on side of basket not free of breaks. |
| Minor | |
| 201 | Basket not stable on flat surface. |
| 202 | Wire ends not properly trimmed. |
| 203 | Baskets not free from dirt, grease, or other foreign material. |
| 204 | Uncoated basket not properly polished. |



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4.3.2 Dimensional examination. The baskets shall be examined for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not within the tolerance specified herein shall be classified as a defect.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Boil test. Type I baskets shall be scrubbed with soap and water, rinsed thoroughly in distilled water, and dried. After cleaning, the baskets shall be boiled in water in a glass vessel for 30 minutes and allowed to remain submerged for an additional 24 hours.

4.4.2 Continuity of coating. The rack shall be immersed in diluted hydrochloric acid (equal parts of conc. H Cl and $H_2$ O by volume) at room temperature for half an hours. Examine for bubbling which is indicative of steel dissolving.

NOTE: Any initial bubbling which may be caused by dissolving metallic dust or dirt shall be disregarded. Only bubbling caused by dissolving the improperly coated steel wire shall be taken into account.

4.4.3 Resistance to steam heat. Baskets to be tested shall be placed in an autoclave that is equipped with controls for maintaining and measuring temperature, and pressure during the autoclaving period. Baskets shall be exposed to steam at a temperature of 121° ± 2° Centigrade (C.) 249.8° ± 3.6° Fahrenheit (F.) for 20 ± 1/2 minute. At the end of the exposure period, the steam shall be blown off and the basket removed from the autoclave within 3 minutes. If any wax or bloom is present on the basket after the exposure period, the basket shall be scrubbed with soap, water, and a soft brush to remove it. The basket shall then be dried in air out of direct light. The exposure and drying shall be repeated until a total of 5 exposures has been completed. The baskets shall be allowed to rest 20 minutes between exposures, from the time it is removed from the steam, before repeating the operation. At the end of the fifth exposure period, the steam shall be blown off, baskets removed from autoclave, and set aside, out of direct light for not less than 16 hours, at room temperature. Examine for deterioration.



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## 5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packing shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One basket of the type and size, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Packaging quantities. The number of units of issue indicated in table V shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

Table V. Packaging Quantities

| Size | Unit package | Intermediate package | Exterior container |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 1 unit | Not required | 12 units |
| 2 | 1 unit | Not required | 48 units |

5.1.2.1 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units in the entire shipment is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units may be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which shall insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Unit package. Each unit shall be packaged in a carton of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676 except that commercial colors are acceptable. Closure shall be adequate to prevent spilling of contents under normal handling.

5.1.4 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.



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5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.2 Case liner. Each Level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. Marking of shipments shall be in accordance with FED-STD-123.

5.3.2 Military activities.

5.3.2.1 Interior packages. Each unit package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.



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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Number and date of this specification.
(b) Federal Stock Number
(c) Type and size basket required (see 1.2).
(d) Selection of applicable levels of packing.

6.2 This specification does not cover all types, classes, grades, or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or those which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types which are normally procured to meet requirements.

6.3 The term vinyl as used in this specification shall be as defined in ASTM D-1784.

6.4 This specification covers the following items shown in the Federal Supply Catalog.

| FSN | Item Identification |
|---|---|
| 6640-299-8479 | BASKET, TEST TUBE |
| 6640-403-0000 | BASKET, TEST TUBE |
| 6640-966-3643 | BASKET, TEST TUBE |
| 6640-966-3644 | BASKET, TEST TUBE |

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
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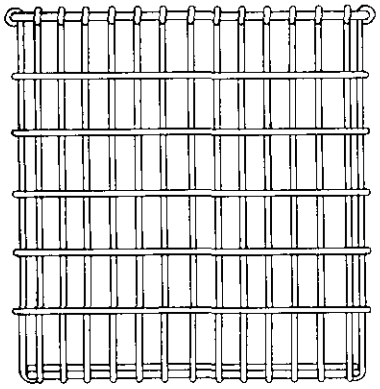
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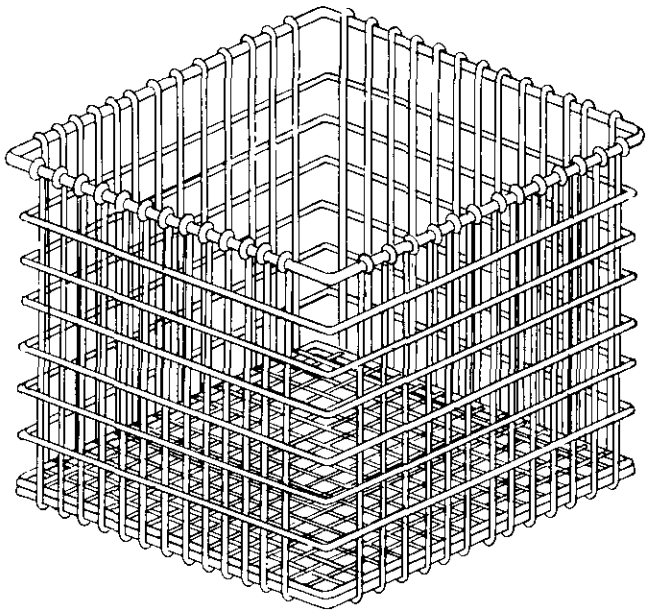
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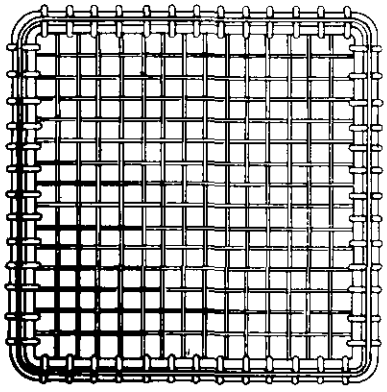
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TEST TUBE BASKET
FIGURE 1



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# SPECIFICATION-ANALYSIS SHEET

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Budget Bureau No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document-(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements .

SPECIFICATION
NNN-B-001291(DSA-DM) FSN:

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE | CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)* | DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 68 1426 REPLACES EDITION OF 1 OCT 64, WHICH MAY BE USED.

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